

Day 5 — Twelve Rāśis

Module: Movement of the Sun · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: name the 12 rāśis in sanskrit and pair with greek zodiac names.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *rāśi* (IAST: rāśi; lit. “1/12th of the ecliptic; zodiacal sign”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define rāśi.** 1/12th of the ecliptic = 30° each. The Sun spends roughly one month in each rāśi.
2. **The 12 Sanskrit names.** *Meṣa*, *Vṛṣabha*, *Mithuna*, *Karka*, *Simha*, *Kanyā*, *Tulā*, *Vṛścika*, *Dhanus*, *Makara*, *Kumbha*, *Mīna*.
3. **Map to Greek/Western zodiac.** *Meṣa* = Aries, *Vṛṣabha* = Taurus, ... *Mīna* = Pisces. The 12-fold division of the ecliptic is widespread across cultures (Babylonian, Greek, Indian, possibly via cultural contact).
4. **Source.** *Bṛhat Saṃhitā* of Varāhamihira (6th c. CE) systematises the 12 rāśis. Earlier references in *Garga Saṃhitā*.
5. **Map current month to current rāśi.** Looking at a sidereal pañcāṅga, identify which rāśi the Sun is in this month. Note the difference from Western (tropical) zodiac dates — we’ll resolve this on Day 7.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sunrise Direction Tracking* (see [activities/](#)). Today’s slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Twelve Rāśis.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).